

William Fawson, PhD

Postdoctoral Research Fellow
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Please feel free to connect with me on [LinkedIn](#).
 For further information, check out my [Personal Website](#).

Summary

My research examines how people build reputations by signalling competence and moral character, and how they convert the resulting status and moral reputation into resources within their organisations. I have presented my research at prestigious academic conferences in North America, Europe, and Asia. I was recently awarded Early Career Scholar by the *International Association for Conflict Management*. My research is currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General* and *Nature Human Behavior* and has been featured in *Forbes Magazine*. At London Business School, I teach Personal Assessment and Development (a core leadership course) to 170 students from the Masters in Finance program, where I received a rating of 4.73/5 (based on 62 student surveys) in the 2025/26 academic year. Before academia, I worked for seven years in London and Amsterdam in finance and strategy consulting. I hold a BSc in Economics and Politics from the University of Bath, an MBA from IESE Business School, and I am a Chartered Accountant in the United Kingdom.

Academic Positions

London Business School – London, United Kingdom	2025-
Postdoctoral Research Fellow (Advisor: Ena Inesi)	Present

Education

IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2021-25
PhD in Management	
• Dissertation: On the Nature, Antecedents and Effects of Status • Cum Laude (Distinction) • Advisors: Anneloes Raes, Sebastien Brion • Committee: Maya Rossignac-Milon, Nicholas Hays, Robert Lount	
IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2019-21
Master of Research in Management	
IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2014-16
Master of Business Administration	
Institute of Chartered Accountant of Scotland – Edinburgh, United Kingdom	2008-11
Chartered Accountant (CA) – Membership Number: M27541	
University of Bath – Bath, United Kingdom	2004-07
Bachelor of Science in Economics and Politics	

Manuscripts under Revise and Resubmit

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders

- Currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*
- Preprint available [here](#)
- Featured in Forbes Magazine:
<https://www.forbes.com/sites/lbsbusinessstrategyreview/2026/02/05/career-capital--why-it-pays-to-challenge-powerful-wrongdoers>
- Featured in London Business School's Think:
<https://www.london.edu/think/moral-courage-is-a-leadership-competency>

Huber, J., Holzknecht, A., Schwaiger, R., Blanco, E., Kirchler, M., et al. (including **Fawson, W.**) Collective Evidence on Behavioral Interventions Targeting Carbon Pricing Support: A Many-Designs Approach with 55 Studies

- Currently under revise and resubmit at *Nature Human Behaviour*

Manuscripts in Preparation for Submission

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. A Social Relations Model Analysis of Status Perceptions

- Preparing for submission (target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2026)

Fawson, W., Inesi, M. E., & Berman, J. Right to Brag? Third-Party Punishment Disclosure Harms Moral Reputation Less Than Helping Disclosure

- Preparing for submission to the *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* (expected submission Summer 2026)
- Preprint available [here](#)

Working Papers

Fawson, W. Deviating from the Status Consensus Reduces Psychological Safety (one study complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Bechara, J. P., & Hays, N. A. Status Dissonance Leads to (Subversive) Status Conflict (two studies complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Lount, R. The Motivational Consequences of Receiving Status Variance (three studies complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2026)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. The Negative Effect of Narcissism on Dyadic Status Exchanges (one study complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Invited Research Talks

London Business School – London, United Kingdom 2025
Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2024). Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Confronting Power-holders

NEOMA Business School – Rouen, France 2023
Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). A Social Relations Model Analysis of Status Perceptions

Chaired Symposia

Fawson, W. (2023). Innovations in Research in Hierarchy. Chaired symposium at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

- Contributors: William Fawson*, Nicholas Hays*, Zhiya Guo, Russell Eric Johnson, Rebecca Mitchell*, Catarina Fernandes, Jo K. Oh, Sebastien Brion, Anneloes Raes, Julian Pfrombeck*, Adam Galinsky, Lindred L. Greer*, Nicole Abi-Esber, and Annebel H.B. De Hoogh (*presenters)

Conference Papers and Talks

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2026). Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., Inesi, M. E., & Berman, J. (2026). Right to Brag? Third-Party Punishment Disclosure Harms Moral Reputation Less Than Helping Disclosure. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., & Brion, S. (2025). Beyond the Individual: Dyadic Drivers of Status. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Hays, N. (2025). The Curvilinear Effect of Receiving Status Dissensus on Effort and Performance. In Zhu, G. (Organizer), *A Social Hierarchy Perspective on Navigating Interpersonal Relationships*. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Bechara, J. P.* (2025). The Effect of Status Deservedness on Dyadic Status Conflict in Groups. Paper presented at the 20th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Rotterdam, Netherlands (*presenter)*

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2024). Patrolling the Powerful: Power Predicts the Reputational Consequences of Third-Party Punishment. Data Blitz presented at the 37th *Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Singapore*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Extraversion Congruence and Status Perception in Groups. In Fawson, W. (Organizer), *Innovations in Research on Hierarchy*. Paper presented at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 18th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Seattle, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 36th Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Thessaloniki, Greece

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A.* (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Status Perception in Groups. Paper presented at the 21st European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress, Katowice, Poland (*presenter)

Awards

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| • Winner: Early Career Scholar, <i>International Association for Conflict Management</i> | 2023 |
| • Nominated: Best Submission, <i>21st European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress</i> | 2023 |

Grants and Fellowships

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| • IESE Doctoral Grant | 2021 |
| • IESE Foundation Fellowship | 2019 |
| • IESE MBA Admissions Scholarship | 2014 |

Teaching

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| Lecturer, London Business School – London, United Kingdom | 2025-Present |
| • Personal Assessment and Development (Masters in Finance; core; 24 sessions) | |
| ◦ Instructor rating: 4.73/5 (based on 62 student surveys) | |
| • Skills for Success (Masters in Financial Analysis; core; 2 sessions) | |
| Guest Lecturer, IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain | 2024-Present |
| • Power & Influence (MBA/EMBA; elective) | |
| Simulation Lead, IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain | 2021-Present |
| • Power & Influence (MBA/EMBA elective) | |

Academic Service

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| Service to IESE Business School | |
| • Organised and chaired 48 one-hour Brown Bag seminars for speakers from IESE Business School, Bayes Business School, Esade and IE Business School | 2021-23 |
| Service to the Academy of Management | 2024-Present |
| • Reviewer for annual conferences | |
| Service to the International Association for Conflict Management | 2023-Present |
| • Reviewer for annual conferences | |
| • Speaker in 2024 Doctoral Student Workshop for the session “Managing the Interview Process” | |
| Service to the Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research | 2023-Present |
| • Reviewer for annual conferences | |

Work Experience

IESE Business School (www.iese.edu) – Barcelona, Spain Associate Director, Career Development Center	2017-19
• Devoted 300 hours to coaching MBA students on breaking into consulting • Built case interview training content, delivered sessions to 150-student consulting club and conducted more than 100 practice interviews • Brought six new consulting firms to campus • Increased placements in top-three strategy consultancies from 28 (year before joining) to 46 (year leaving)	
Monitor Deloitte (www.deloitte.com) – Amsterdam, Netherlands Strategy Consulting Manager (initially MBA Intern)	2015-17
• Developed growth strategy for a Polish energy provider • Led commercial activities in two départements for three months at a French energy provider • Managed hiring of MBA for Deloitte's Dutch practice	
IHG Hotels & Resorts (www.ihgplc.com) – London, United Kingdom Corporate Finance Manager	2012-14
• Analysed the company's financial performance and prepared the CFO to discuss results and outlook in Executive Committee meetings each month • Coordinated the company's annual budget process • Worked closely with Investor Relations to manage external analyst coverage • Calculated annual bonuses for corporate employees across the company	
EY (www.ey.com) – London, United Kingdom Audit Senior Associate (initially: Audit Associate)	2008-12
• Managed audits for a major UK-based telco • Supervised IPO on the New York Stock Exchange for a large software provider • Studied and passed exams to become a Chartered Accountant	

Languages

English: Mother Tongue

Italian: Good

Spanish: Good

French: Basic

Interests

I do my best to keep active, and particularly enjoy going to the gym, running, and hiking. Once in a while I do big challenges – these have included five marathons in Barcelona, and cycling the 4,000km perimeter of the Iberian Peninsula

References

Anneloes Raes

Professor and Head of Department

Managing People in Organizations

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Sebastien Brion

Professor

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Ena Inesi

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